

25/7/26

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UNIT: 1

ANALYTICAL QUESTIONS

1. • Key = 3
• Plaintext = MEET ME AFTER THE TOGA PARTY
• Found by trying all 26 keys (brute force.)
2. • Cipher text: DPNFCTET
• Formula $C: (P+11) \% 26$
3. • Only 26 keys
• Easy to try all keys (brute-force attack)
4. • Letters keep same frequency.
• Attackers use frequency analysis to guess letters
5. • Cipher: Atbash cipher.
• Plaintext: THIS IS A SECRET
6. • Assume $X = E$
• Then test other common letters & words
7. • One letter can become different ciphertext letters
• Frequency analysis becomes harder.
8. • Ciphertext = MVWZXMQVYZLW
• Use key repeatedly for encryption.
9. • Plaintext = ATTACK AT DAWN
10. • Repeated key creates patterns.
• Kasiski attack finds key length & helps break cipher

11.
 - It becomes a One-Time Pad.
 - It is unbreakable if key is truly random & use only once.
12.
 - Monoalphabetic = One fixed substitution less secure.
 - Polyalphabetic = Multiple substitution more secure.
13.
 - Letters are treated as numbers ($A=0, B=1, \dots, Z=25$).
 - Encryption & decryption use mod 26.
14.
 - Plaintext = HI
 - Ciphertext = TC
15.
 - If key matrix has no inverse, decryption is not possible.
16.
 - So key matrix has inverse.
 - Without it decryption fails.
17.
 - It encrypts blocks of letters using matrix multiplication.
18.
 - It is likely a polyalphabetic substitution cipher.
 - Frequency analysis becomes difficult.
19.
 - Use random letter mapping.
 - Share key through secure / private channel.
20.
 - Yes, ciphertext blocks will also be same if same key is used.
21.
 - No
 - It is Affine cipher, not Caesar (shift)

22.

- The attacker knows some plaintext & its ciphertext.
- Hence find encryption key.

23.

- It changes letters using different shifts.
- But 1 plaintext letter affects only 1 ciphertext.

24.

- "THE" is very common in English.
- Attackers match patterns to guess letters substituted.

25.

- Caesar Cipher
- Monoalphabetic Cipher
- Vigenere Cipher
- Hill Cipher

26.

- Verify zig-zag placement of letters.
- If ciphertext doesn't match, rail traversal was done incorrectly.

27.

- Fill table row by row.
- Add padding if last row is incomplete.

28.

- Repeated letters make column numbering confusing.
- Use fixed rule to order equal letters.

29.

- Verify that letters follow correct zig-zag path.
- If not, cipher text is incorrect.

30.

- Possible matrix sizes depend on message length.

ciphertext

31. • Reconstruct columns using key order.
• Rearrange columns to find plaintext.

32. • Reconstruct columns using key order.
• Rearrange columns to find plaintext.

plaintext

33. • This can happen if keys produce some column order.

substitution

34. • Try 2, 3, 4, ... rails.

- Choose result that gives meaningful english text.

35. • More key permutations
• Brute-force attack becomes much harder.

36. • Attackers can guess padding.
• This may reveal message structure.

versal

37. • Matrix size options are limited.
• Padding is usually required.

38. • Decryption gives meaningless text.
• Correct row/column order is essential.

using

39. • They stay on first & last rails.
• So they often remain in same position.

better

40. • Total cells = 24 (6x4)
• 1 cell is left empty.

th.

41. • Each 5 - letter key $5! = 120$
combinations = $120 \times 120 = 14400$
42. • Try single transposition first.
• If it fails, try double.
43. • Repeated letters make column ranking confusing.
44. • It usually indicates columnar transposition.
• Rail Fence work slow.
45. • It suggest no. of rails was chosen as letters are evenly spread.
46. • This is slightly weakened cipher.
• May create patterns
47. • Padding is added to fill empty cells.
• so ciphertext length increases.
48. • $6! = 720$
• Brute force approach
49. • Compare result using 2 rails & 3 rails.
• Correct rail no. is CRYPTOGRAPHY.
50. • Numeric Key: Easy to use
• Keyword keys: Easy to remember.